Incoming Material Inspection Standard

Purpose and Scope

This standard describes how Riverbend Packaging inspects raw materials and packaging components on receipt, including bottles, caps, labels, cartons, and bulk product ingredients. Inspection prevents defective supplier material from entering production and supports supplier performance tracking.

Receiving Flow

1. The receiving clerk verifies the purchase order, supplier, quantity, and lot codes against the packing slip.
2. Check the condition of the pallets and packaging for damage, moisture, or pests.
3. Apply a yellow QUARANTINE tag to every pallet.
4. Notify Quality that material is ready for inspection.
5. Quality samples and inspects according to the plan.
6. Accepted material is tagged green and moved to the warehouse; rejected material is tagged red and held.

Sampling Plan

Sampling follows ANSI/ASQ Z1.4, general inspection level II, with the acceptable quality limits below.

Defect class	AQL	Examples
Critical	0	Foreign material, contamination, wrong material
Major	1.0	Cracked bottle neck, out-of-dimension thread, missing liner
Minor	2.5	Cosmetic scuffs, minor label misprint

Lot size	Sample size	Accept / Reject (Major, AQL 1.0)
281 to 500	50	1 / 2
501 to 1,200	80	2 / 3
1,201 to 3,200	125	3 / 4
3,201 to 10,000	200	5 / 6

Inspection Checks

Bottles

1. Measure neck finish dimensions with go/no-go gauges.
2. Check height and diameter with calipers.
3. Inspect for cracks, chips, and inclusions under a light.
4. Verify cleanliness by inverting and examining for particles.

Caps and Closures

1. Measure outside diameter and thread dimensions.
2. Confirm the liner is present and seated.
3. Check tamper band integrity.
4. Run a fit test with a sample of production bottles.

Labels and Cartons

1. Verify artwork against the approved proof, including lot code and regulatory text.
2. Check adhesive and print quality.
3. Confirm carton dimensions with a test fit.

Certificates and Documentation

Each lot of bulk ingredient must arrive with a certificate of analysis (COA) that matches the specification. Quality reviews the COA before release. A missing or non-matching COA is a critical defect and the lot is held.

Disposition of Rejected Material

Rejected lots are tagged and recorded in the quality system and handled under the Nonconformance and Hold Procedure. Quality contacts the supplier within one business day and requests a corrective action response within 10 business days. Material may be returned, sorted at the supplier's cost, or scrapped.

Supplier Performance

Quality calculates monthly supplier scorecards from lot acceptance rate, delivery timeliness, and corrective action response. Suppliers below 95 percent acceptance for two consecutive months are placed on probation.

Storage and Handling

Store accepted caps and bottles in covered, dry, clean areas off the floor. Rotate stock first in, first out. Do not open sealed cartons until needed on the line.

Records

Inspection records, COAs, and supplier correspondence are retained for three years. Gauges used for inspection are calibrated annually and tagged with the next due date.

Receipts Outside Normal Hours

Material received on weekends or overnight is quarantined by the receiving clerk and remains tagged yellow until Quality inspects it on the next business day. Production may not use quarantined material. If a line is at risk of stopping, the Quality Engineer may authorize a conditional release after reviewing the certificate of analysis and a reduced inspection of critical attributes. Conditional releases are recorded, the lot is traced in production, and full inspection is completed as soon as possible. Any failure found afterward triggers a hold on all product made with that lot.